

BUSINESS START-UP GUIDE



From Idea to Income

*Your Step-by-Step Roadmap to
Launching a Profitable Business*

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I. Our Why



Why do we want to start a business?

The answer is simple but powerful: Because we have the unique ability to add value to the marketplace and make a profit while doing it. As purpose-driven entrepreneurs, we are called to solve problems and serve our communities.

The Tax Code Advantage

The United States tax code is not just a set of rules for collecting revenue; it is actually a series of incentives designed to encourage specific behaviors that grow the economy. The tax code heavily incentivizes three distinct groups of people:

- Business Owners
- Investors
- Real Estate Owners

To build true generational wealth and achieve financial freedom, you must position yourself to be one or more of these! This guide will help you take that crucial first step.

II. Business Set-Up Steps

Step 1: Verify Your Business Name

Before you invest time and money into branding, you must ensure your desired business name is legally available. Do not skip this step!

- Check general availability on platforms like ZenBusiness.
- Verify federal trademark status at the official US Trademark Office (USPTO).

Step 2: Set Up a Domain and Business Email

Your business deserves to be represented professionally and taken seriously. Using a standard Gmail or Yahoo address signals that you are running a hobby, not a business. A professional email (e.g., hello@yourbrand.com) requires a host domain.

Recommended domain and hosting providers: GoDaddy, Zoho, Cloudflare, Namecheap, and Hostinger.

Step 3: File with the Secretary of State

To legally operate, you must register your business entity (Corporation, Non-Profit, LLC, or Partnership) with your state. For example, in Mississippi:

- Use Google Chrome or Firefox for the best portal experience.
- Navigate to the Secretary of State portal.
- Select 'Business Services and Regulations' → 'File Business Documents'.
- Follow the prompts to complete your formation filings.

Resource Tip: For a full step-by-step guide, LLC University is an excellent resource. If you need a Registered Agent, Northwest Registered Agent is highly recommended. While you can serve as your own Registered Agent, make sure you

fully understand the privacy and legal risks involved.

Recommended Formation Service: Bizee (formerly Incfile)

Arise Credit Pro recommends **Bizee** (formerly Incfile) for fast, affordable, and reliable business formation. With over two decades of experience and a 4.7-star Trustpilot rating, Bizee helps entrepreneurs form LLCs, S Corps, C Corps, and nonprofits — all in one place. They also handle Annual Reports, Virtual Addresses, and ongoing compliance so you stay in good standing with your state.

Service	Details
Business Formation	LLC, S Corp, C Corp, Nonprofit
Annual Report Filing	Stay compliant and in good standing with your state
Virtual Address	Protect your privacy with a real street address
Trustpilot Rating	4.7 out of 5 — Excellent
Customer Support	Real people, English & Spanish, Mon-Fri 9am-6pm CST
Get Started	bizee.com

Arise Credit Pro Tip: Use Bizee to form your LLC quickly and correctly from day one. A properly registered business entity is the foundation of your business credit profile and the first step toward accessing funding and business tradelines.

III. Understand WHO Your Real Customer Is

One of the biggest mistakes new entrepreneurs make is confusing the end-user with the actual buyer. Your 'Real' customer is defined by two specific criteria:

1. Who loses sleep if the problem is not solved?
2. Who has the authority and the financial resources to fix it?

The Real Customer Guide

Save time and money by understanding exactly who you are targeting.

Product / Service	The 'Real' Customer Analysis
1. Happy Meals (McDonald's)	The child wants the toy, but the real customer is the tired parent who wants a fast, cheap, no-argument dinner solution. They are selling peace to the parent.
2. Pediatricians	The patient is the child, but the real customer is the anxious parent who needs reassurance and clear communication. The kid doesn't write the check.
3. College Admissions	The student is the subject, but the real customer is the parent terrified their child will fall behind—and has \$5K–\$10K to spend on that fear.
4. Wedding Vendors	The couple is getting married, but the real buyer decision often runs through whoever is funding the wedding (often a parent with a checkbook).
5. Youth Sports	Kids play, but the real customer is the parent who believes this investment will build character, college prospects, or athletic scholarships.
6. Luxury Baby Products	The baby has zero preferences. The real customer is the new parent who needs to feel like a 'good parent.' You are selling identity and status.
7. Business Coaching	The business owner is the client, but if they are married, their spouse is often the silent decision-maker. If the spouse doesn't trust the investment, the sale dies.

Product / Service	The 'Real' Customer Analysis
8. Senior Living Facilities	The resident is the end user, but the real customer is the overwhelmed adult child who desperately needs to believe their parent will be safe and happy.
9. HR Software	Employees use it daily, but the real customer is the HR Director or CFO who needs to justify the budget, reduce liability, and look competent to the board.
10. Church Youth Programs	Teens attend, but the real customer is the parent who wants their child in a safe, values-aligned environment—and who decides where the family tithes.

IV. Understand WHAT Problem You Are Solving

In the world of selling, people do not buy products or features—they buy freedom from pain. You must articulate the deep, underlying problem your service resolves.

The Real Problem Guide

Industry / Business Type	The Core Problem The Buyer Needs Solved
1. McDonald's Happy Meal	Dinner-Time Stress & Parental Decision Fatigue
2. Pediatrician / Clinic	Parental Anxiety & the Need for Clear Medical Guidance
3. College Admissions	College Acceptance Fear & Competitive Admissions Anxiety
4. Wedding Vendors	Budget Stress & Multi-Stakeholder Decision Chaos
5. Youth Sports Academy	Parental Investment Anxiety & Child Development Concern
6. Premium Baby Brands	First-Time Parent Overwhelm & the Fear of Choosing Wrong
7. Business Coach	Entrepreneurial Isolation & Household Financial Fear
8. Senior Living Facility	Adult Child Caregiver Burnout & Placement Guilt
9. HR Software Platform	Executive Accountability & HR Compliance Risk
10. Church Youth Program	Parental Fear of Cultural Influence & Teen Spiritual Drift

V. Your Personal Business Profile Prompt

Now, let's combine your 'Real Customer' and your 'Real Problem' specifically for your business. Use this keyword-rich, SEO-optimized prompt in your favorite AI tool (ChatGPT, Claude, etc.) to gain crystal-clear clarity on your brand messaging.

I am building a [business / brand / offer / product / service] in the [industry/niche] space. I need your help getting crystal clear on three things that will directly impact my ability to attract my ideal customer, rank for high-intent keywords, and generate consistent revenue.

Please help me identify and articulate:

1. My REAL Target Audience

Not a vague demographic – I want a specific, high-converting customer avatar. Who is the person most likely to buy, take action, and get results? Include their age range, lifestyle, mindset, online behavior, and the exact search terms they type into Google when they're ready to solve their problem. Think buyer intent keywords, long-tail search phrases, and psychographic triggers.

2. My REAL Core Problem I Solve

Not what I think I'm selling – what transformation am I actually delivering? Frame it in the language my customer uses, not industry jargon. What is the before-and-after of working with me? Make this SEO-rich: what problem-aware keywords, solution-aware phrases, and competitor-aware search queries align with the outcome I provide?

3. The NAGGING Pain Point

What is the one thing that keeps my ideal customer up at night – the frustration they've tried to fix, the fear they won't admit, the thing they've Googled 50 times hoping for a real answer? Give me the emotional language, the internal monologue, and the exact phrases they use when venting to a friend or posting in a Facebook group. This is my conversion copy goldmine.

For each of the three areas above, also give me:

- 3-5 high-intent SEO keywords or phrases my audience is actually searching
- A one-sentence value proposition I can use in headlines, ads, or bio copy

- One insight I'm probably overlooking that could immediately increase my revenue

My business context: [Describe what you do, who you serve, and what result you help them achieve – in 2-4 sentences.]

VI. Don't Sell What You Think. Sell What People Are Buying!

Market Research is Non-Negotiable

Before you launch a product based on what you **think** people need, you must verify what they are actually spending money on.

- Do research on sites like Reddit, Facebook Groups, Google Trends, Etsy, Amazon Best Sellers, or Pinterest.
- Note: Always look at these sites for yourself to understand the landscape before asking AI to assist you.

The Market Validation AI Prompt

Once you have a general idea, insert the below prompt into ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini to validate and structure your product suite:

"Now, do the research on the above sources and give me 5 in-demand products that will make me \$10,000 by December 2026? Here is my audience and value statement below."

Sample Value Statement:

"I help purpose-driven women of faith stay calm in conflict so that they can retire early and start their businesses without fear, overwhelm, or frustration."

When executed correctly, this exercise will provide you with a structured product ladder (e.g., a low-ticket eBook, a mid-ticket online course, a monthly membership, a template bundle, and a high-ticket 1:1 coaching intensive) designed to hit your revenue goals.

VII. Take Your Idea to Market



You have your business entity, you understand your real customer, you've identified their core problem, and you've validated your product suite. Now, it is time to launch.

Fast & Free Launch Platforms

Do not let technology hold you back. There are platforms designed specifically to help creators and consultants get to market rapidly.

- **Beacons.ai:** An incredibly fast, link-in-bio style platform where you can set up a storefront and start accepting payments in about 20 minutes.
- **Systeme.io:** A slightly longer setup time, but offers a robust, free all-in-one marketing platform including funnels, email marketing, and course hosting.

Comprehensive E-Commerce Options

As your business scales, you may want to transition to more comprehensive platforms to showcase and sell your products:

- **Shopify:** The industry standard for physical and digital e-commerce.
- **Wix:** Excellent for service-based businesses needing beautiful portfolio sites.
- **Hostinger:** Great for affordable, self-hosted WordPress sites.

Your business journey starts now. Take action, stay focused on solving real problems, and build the legacy you were meant to create. Arise Credit Pro is with you every step of the way.

VIII. Business Setup & Credit 90-Day Checklist

Use this checklist to track each step required to build a legally established, credit-ready business. Check off each item as it is completed and record notes where needed. Completing these steps in order will position your business to access funding, open trade accounts, and establish a strong business credit profile.

Business Setup Checklist

D o n e	Action Item	Resource
■	Obtain a business address	<i>ipostal1.com</i>
■	Obtain a business telephone number	<i>Grasshopper.com</i>
■	Obtain Articles of Incorporation	<i>Secretary of State</i>
■	Obtain EIN number	<i>irs.gov</i>
■	Purchase Domain Name	<i>domains.google.com</i>
■	Set up professional email (add-on after domain purchase)	
■	Obtain DUNS Number	<i>dnb.com</i>
■	Set up Business Profile on Google	<i>google.com/business</i>
■	Open Business Bank Account	<i>Chase, BOA, or choice</i>
■	Set up Business Merchant Account	<i>Stripe, PayPal, Paysley, Joist, etc.</i>

D o n e	Action Item	Resource
■	Create NAV account	nav.com

Business Tradelines Checklist

Building business tradelines is one of the fastest ways to establish a strong business credit profile. The accounts below report to business credit bureaus and can help you qualify for larger funding lines over time.

D o n e	Account	Cost	Notes
■	Nav Boost	\$39.99/month	Reports business credit activity
■	Biz Credit Central	\$11.99/month	\$2,500 Line of Credit
■	Ecredable Business Lift	\$9.95/month	Reports in 1-2 weeks
■	Red Spectrum	\$54.99/month	\$2,500 Line of Credit
■	Credit Strong (For Business)	\$99-\$115/month	Installment tradeline
■	Business Net 30 Accounts	Varies	U-Line, Quill, Grainger, etc.

Notes / Completion Dates

Use the space below to record important notes, completion dates, account numbers, or any follow-up actions required for each step.

Arise Credit Pro Tip: Complete the Business Setup Checklist in order before applying for any business credit. Lenders and vendors verify these foundational elements before approving your business for tradelines or funding.